Sankhya Philosophy

And its Educational Implications

Sankhya Philosophy & sources

1. It is based upon the work of Sage **Kapila** (written sankhya sutra)
2. **Sankhya karika** by **Iswarkrishna**
3. **Sankhya karika bhashya** by **Gaudapada**
4. **Tattwakaumudi** by **Vachaspati**
5. **Sankhya pravachana bhashya** and **Sankhya sara** by **Vigyannabhiskhu/ Vijnanabhiksu**
6. **Sankhya pravachana sutra britti** by **Aniruddha**

Meaning

1. It is explained in different ways
2. 1st interpretation is that Sankhya refers to **Number**: because it aims at right knowledge of reality by **enumeration of the ultimate objects of knowledge**
3. 1st interpretation is that Sankhya means **Samyag Jnana** - **perfect knowledge**
4. It also known as **dualistic realism**- because it recognise 2 types of ultimate realities: **Purusha & Prakruti**

Sankhya Theory of Reality

1. **Satkarya Vada** (Theory of Causation): effect exists In the material cause before it is produced
   a. **Parinama vada** (real transformation): when effect is produced there is real transformation of the cause into the effect (pot from clay; curd from milk)
   b. **Vivarta vada**(merely apparent): it is when the change of the cause into the effect is merely apparent (statue of any animal)

2. **Prakruti and Gunas**: Prakruti as the ultimate cause of the world of objects
   a. It constituted of **3 gunas** (elements)
      i. **Sattwa**:it is of pleasure & is light and bright (evaporation; satisfaction, joy, happiness)
      ii. **Raja**: is the principle of activity in things; it is of the nature of pain and mobile; it always moves and makes other things moves (wind blow, fire spread; restless in mind)
      iii. **Tamas**: is the principle of passivity & negativity in things; it is heavy opposed to **Sattwa** and **Raja** as well; produce ignorance and darkness

iv. They **always go together** and **never be separated from each other**; nor can any one of them can produce anything without support of other 2

v. 3 gunas present in **every thing of the world**

vi. Each of them tries to **suppress and dominate** the others

vii. The **nature of things is determined by the predominant guna**

viii. Gunas are subject to **constant change and transformation**

ix. There are **2 types transformation** of guna

1. **Swarupaparinama** (homogeneous change): change within itself, without disturbing others
2. **Virupaparinama** (heterogeneous change): interact among gunas

Purusha (Self)

1. Another ultimate reality according to Sankhya is **Purusha** (self)
2. Everybody feels s/he exists
3. The feelings of one's own existence is natural
4. Self is **pure, eternal**
5. It is **different from** body, senses, mind and intellect
6. It is a **conscious spirit**- **subject of knowledge**; **not the object of knowledge**
7. Sankhya believe in **plurality of selves**

Evolution of the World

- **Prakruti** evolves the world of objects when it comes into **relation** with the **Purusha**
- Combination of **3 gunas in different proportion** originates the various objects of the world
- 1st product of evolution is **Mahat/ Buddhi** (intellect): function is taking decision
- 2nd- **Ahankara** (ego): consider itself to be an agent/ cause of action, owner of properties
- 3rd- **Manas** (mind): is the central organ which participate in and consume of the nature of organs of knowledge and action

- 4th- **5 organ of knowledge**/perception: senses of sight, hearing, smell & touch
- 5th- **5 organs of action**: Mouth, Hands, Feet, Excretion organ & Reproduction organ
- 6th- **5 Tanmatras**: potential elements of sound, touch, colour, taste and smell
- 7th- **5 Mahabhutas**: Prithvi(Earth), Apas(आपः Water), Agni (अग्नि, Fire), Vayu (वायुः, Air), Akasha(आकाश, Space/Atmosphere/Ether)

Sankhya Theory of Knowledge

- Valid knowledge is **definite and perfect cognition of object**
- **Ignorance** is the cause of suffering
- Right knowledge of reality liberate from suffering: **Jivanmukti** & **Videhamukti**
- **3 sources** of valid knowledge
- **Perception**: direct cognition of an object through sense
- **Inference**: conclusion draw on the basis of reasoning and evidences
- **Testimony**: scriptures, texts etc.

Educational Implications

Aims of Education

- Liberation from sufferings
- Knowing the sufferings
- Knowledge about the ultimate realities
- All Round development of personality- physical & intellectual
- Control over sense organs

Curriculum

- **Veda- (Rig, sam, yajur, atharva), upaveda (ayur- medicine & life sc., Dhanur- Warfare, Arthashastra- Business & Admini., Gaandhar- Art, music & Dance)**
- **Vedanga- Siksha (Phonetics), Vyakarana, Chhanda (linguistics rhythm), Nirukta (etymology), Jyotish (astronomy), Kalps (rituals)**
- **Natural sciences** and **social sciences**
- Language and **Philosophy**
- Physical activities
- **Scriptures** and **texts** on reality written by eminent personalities

Methods of Teaching & Learning

- Lecture
- Debate & Discussion
- Sravana: Attentive listening
- Manana: critical thinking
- Swadhyaya: self study
- Exposures

Role of Teacher & Teacher-Taught Relation

- Teacher as **Torch bearer** of knowledge
- He is **leader** and **guide**
- He must know the **path of liberation**, person of knowledge about ultimate reality
- Relation b/w teacher and learner should be **cordial** as father and son

School & Discipline

- School is the **place of learning about realities**
- It provides **all sorts of exposure** to remove **darkness** and **ignorance**
- Provide both **Paramarthik** (liberation) & **Laukika** (worldly) knowledge
- Advocates for **strict discipline** but more emphasized on **self discipline**
- **Sanjama** (self control) is to be practised by all